

Lesson 12

WORDS TO LEARN

ability
apply
background
be ready for
call in
confidence
constantly
expert
follow up
hesitant
present
weakly

Applying and Interviewing

Study the following definitions and examples.

1. **ability** n., a skill, a competence
 - a. The designer's ability was obvious from her portfolio.
 - b. The ability to work with others is a key requirement.
2. **apply** v., to look for; to submit an application
 - a. The college graduate applied for three jobs and received three offers.
 - b. Everyone who is interested should apply in person at any branch office.
3. **background** n., a person's experience, education, and family history
 - a. Your background in the publishing industry is a definite asset for this job.
 - b. The employer did a complete background check before offering him the job.
4. **be ready for** v., to be prepared
 - a. Thanks to her careful research, the applicant felt that she was ready for the interview with the director of the program.
 - b. The employer wasn't ready for the applicant's questions.
5. **call in** v., to ask to come; to beckon
 - a. The young woman was so excited when she was called in for an interview that she told everyone she knew.
 - b. The human resources manager called in all the qualified applicants for a second interview.
6. **confidence** n., a belief in one's abilities, self-esteem
 - a. Good applicants show confidence during an interview.
 - b. He had too much confidence and thought that the job was his.
7. **constantly** adj., on a continual basis, happening all the time
 - a. The company is constantly looking for highly trained employees.
 - b. Martin constantly checked his messages to see if anyone had called for an interview.
8. **expert** n., a specialist
 - a. Our department head is an expert in financing.
 - b. The candidate demonstrated that he was an expert in marketing.
9. **follow up** v., to take additional steps, to continue; n., the continuation of a previous action
 - a. Always follow up an interview with a thank-you note.
 - b. As a follow up, the candidate sent the company a list of references.
10. **hesitant** adj., reluctant; with reservation
 - a. Marla was hesitant about negotiating a higher salary.
 - b. The recent college graduate was hesitant about accepting his first offer.
11. **present** v., to introduce; to show; to offer for consideration
 - a. The human resources director presents each candidate's résumé to the department supervisor for review.
 - b. The candidate presented her qualifications so well that the employer offered her a job on the spot.
12. **weakly** adv., without strength; poorly
 - a. Her hands trembled and she spoke weakly at the interview.
 - b. She wrote so weakly we couldn't read it.